

User Document Assignment Scenario

 tracigardner.github.io/TechComm/assignments/user-doc/user-document-scenario-v2.html

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Caldwell Communications Project (Fall 2026)

Project Lead: Geoff Fitzwilliam

Charge Code: 26-3612

Client Request: Develop a one-page learning aid that helps employees understand and apply important concepts related to plain language, document accessibility, and effective document design.

Client Overview

Client: W. A. Caldwell & Associates

Client Address: 110 Hokie Stone Way, Suite 210, Blacksburg, VA 24060

Key Contact: Luci Lee, Director of Research & Development, llee@caldwellassociates.com

Background: W. A. Caldwell & Associates is a regional consulting firm that manages major municipal, state, and federal contracts. Its employees regularly create reports, policy briefs, proposals, presentations, instructions, and other documents for clients, government agencies, and members of the public.

Overall Project Goals

Caldwell & Associates (C&A) has begun a company-wide communications initiative to help employees create documents that are **clear, usable, accessible, and well designed**. The initiative focuses on three related areas:

- **Plain language** that readers can easily understand and use
- **Document accessibility** for readers with different abilities and technologies
- **Document design** that organizes and presents information effectively

Maroon + Orange Digital (M+OD) is helping C&A develop practical resources for these areas, including a collection of one-page learning aids employees can consult while creating and revising workplace documents.

Your Role & Objective

As a Communications Consultant at M+OD, your job is to develop practical resources that employees can use to improve the clarity, accessibility, and design of their workplace documents.

Luci Lee, Director of R&D, has asked M+OD to create a collection of one-page learning aids and visual glossaries that explain small, related groups of concepts associated with **plain language, document accessibility, or effective document design**. C&A employees will use these resources as quick references while writing, designing, and revising workplace documents.

Possible Concepts

Each learning aid should focus on a **small, coherent group of related concepts** associated with plain language, accessibility, or document design. Possible concepts include:

- Accessible typography
- Alternative text
- Chunking information
- Color and color contrast
- Concise language
- Descriptive headings
- Descriptive link text
- Document navigation
- Heading levels
- Information hierarchy
- Jargon and technical terminology
- Lists
- Logical reading order
- Meaningful images
- Page layout
- Plain language
- Reader-centered writing
- Screen readers
- Tables and table structure
- Visual hierarchy
- White space

These examples are starting points rather than a required list. Your learning aid should focus on concepts that **fit together logically** and can be explained effectively within a one-page

document.

💡 Most of these concepts could be broken out into a full sheet of related terms. For instance, if you chose *Accessible Typography* as your starting point, your Learning Aid might cover concepts like font size, font face, font color, line spacing, and color.